

on the Realme 11 Pro+ are very good. The photos are detailed and the colour representation is also very close to accurate. While the images in normal mode are very good, in 200-megapixel, I found the camera to be taking in way too much light in very bright environments, which results in blown-up colours and crushed details. I faced this challenge only once with the Realme 11 Pro+. That too, on a day when the sun was as bright as it can be. Even if this is a widespread issue, it can be easily fixed with a software update. The Realme 11 Pro+ also comes with a lot of interesting features that we haven't seen on other smartphones previously. The smartphone comes with up to 4X "lossless" zoom, which is the company's term for its new zoom technique.

Now, this basically crops the image from the primary shooter and given the 200-megapixels, the quality and details remain intact most of the time. Of course, this isn't as good as proper optical zoom, but the images look way better than any other 4X digital zoom on any smartphone camera.

Apart from this, the images in wide angle are also very good in general, but similar to other smartphones from the brand, the consistency isn't really good and the difference between the primary and wide-angle photos is very evident.

Coming to portraits, edge detection is very good on the smartphone, and the portrait mode doesn't hamper much with the subject's skin tones and colours. Now, it still doesn't compare with other heavy-duty camera phones out there, but it is easily one of the best in this segment.

PERFORMANCE

Performance-wise, the Realme 11 Pro+ disappointed me a little bit. The smartphone uses a MediaTek Dimensity 7050 chipset paired with up to 12GB of RAM. While the RAM is more than enough for a smartphone, using a MediaTek Dimensity 7050 has put the Realme 11 Pro+ way behind competitors like the Poco F5 and iQOO Neo 7 in terms of performance. The benchmark numbers are not even close

to the two more powerful devices in this range. In fact, in our tests, the Realme 11 Pro+ showed a lower AnTuTu score than its smaller sibling, the Realme 10 Pro.

Now, you won't feel the lack of power in day-to-day usage and yes, Realme's focus this time around is not on performance, but on the camera, but given the 200-megapixel shooter and the slew of camera features that the company has given, the camera processing feels a bit slow, especially while using the camera in full 200-megapixel mode.

Another issue with the smartphone is the software. While the UI and experience is very similar to the newer OnePlus and Oppo smartphones, the issue is bloatware. Similar to the Realme 10 Pro series, the Realme 11 Pro devices are also loaded with bloatware. Apart from your basic partner apps like some local social media apps and Realme's own apps, there are three folders that are only there to give you the option of downloading some more partner apps. Yes, these apps aren't installed in the smartphone, but you can't even remove these folders.

Furthermore, there are too many permissions and pop-ups to go through while setting up the smartphone initially which is a bit annoying. There are also these full-screen pop ups in Realme UI that ask you to "scan" or "open" an app. Upon start-up, I got at least 7 of these pop-ups. Not a good experience, especially when it is the first time a user has booted the device. During the Realme 11 Pro launch, the brand did tell us a way to avoid these pop-ups, but since most users won't know how to do that, it is still a big negative in terms of the overall experience. Yes, it comes up every time you download a new app, unless you close it from the settings or during setup.

BATTERY

Battery on the Realme 11 Pro+ is good. The smartphone doesn't drain a lot of battery, even during heavy-duty tasks like gaming or GPS navigation. We played an HDR video on YouTube at full resolution and brightness, and the smartphone only lost 4 percent battery. 1 hour of GPS navigation only drained 5 per cent of the

battery, which is very good. The battery is good, the charging speed is even better. The Realme 11 Pro+ comes with 100W fast charging and I put this to test. Here, the smartphone charged from 0 to 100 per cent in just 27 minutes. This basically means you can put your phone on charge in the morning and by the time you make your tea or coffee, or even brush your teeth, you will have enough juice to last a full day.

VERDICT

So the Realme 11 Pro+ has given Realme a much-needed redemption in the camera space. It uses one of the most advanced camera hardware in the whole market, which has paid off quite well, barring a couple of minor rough edges here and there. The smartphone's display is the hidden gem and it turns out to be one of the best displays we have tested in this segment. Apart from all this, the smartphone's design is stunning. As mentioned earlier, this is probably the best looking smartphone in this segment in my opinion.

However, the good camera, design and display come at the cost of performance and user experience. The MediaTek Dimensity 7050 feels underpowered when put to test despite the 12GB RAM and the bloatware issue is so bad that people have been talking about it since even before the smartphone was launched. Overall, it is a decent upgrade, but it is high time Realme does something about the software, at least on a smartphone that costs around Rs 30,000 or more.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: MediaTek Dimensity 7050 | GPU: Mali-G68 MC4 | OS: RealmeUI 14.0 based on Android 13 | Display: 6.7-inch FHD+ AMOLED display | Display Refresh Rate: 120Hz | RAM: Up to 12GB | ROM: Up to 256GB | Cameras (rear): 200MP + 8MP + 2MP | Cameras (front): 32MP | Video: 4K @ 30fps | Battery: 5000mAh | Charging: 100W

CONTACT

Name: Realme | Phone: 1800 102 2777 | Email: service@realme.com | Website: <https://www.realme.com/in/>